

which has been working with data centre providers in India on their power requirements. “If you’re going to talk about 1000s of megawatts getting consumed in a single location, it becomes a business of power and that’s the problem that we are trying to solve,” says Ankit Saraiya, Director and CEO, Techno Digital. The focus is also on sourcing power from sustainable sources. Techno Digital’s next facility coming up in Chennai will have the first 100% carbon neutral hyperscale design, powered through renewable energy sourcing.

### NEWER HUBS

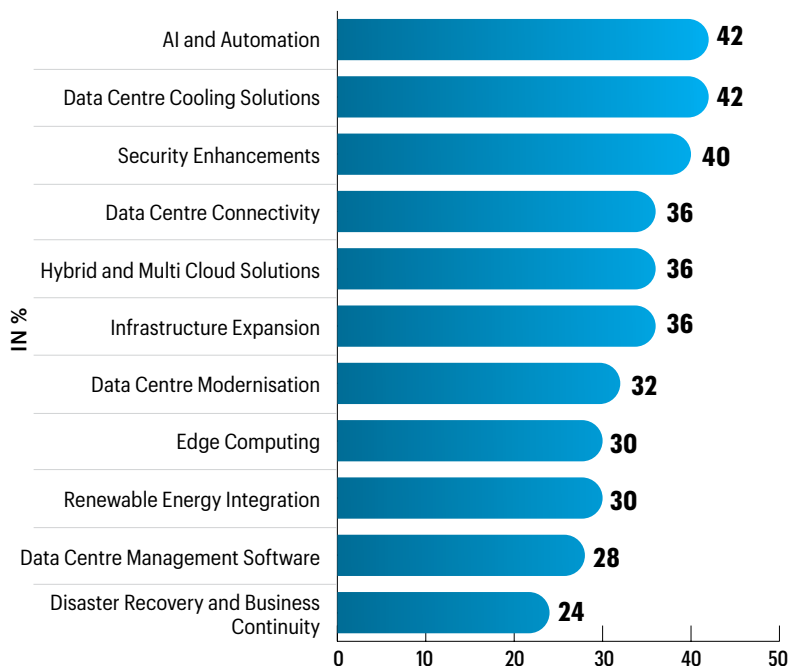
Another major transitional point is the focus on Tier II cities. At present, a majority of data centres in India are in Mumbai and Chennai because of access to subsea cables for latency, or minimal lag, as well as proximity to the financial centres (Mumbai), which are the biggest users of these facilities. Mumbai alone hosts over 50% of the country’s data centre capacity, but this is slowly changing. Companies are setting up smaller or edge data centres to be closer to consumers.

Many of these are expected to come up in places like Jaipur, Bhubaneswar, Vizag and Patna, either to be close to the coast, a large industrial cluster (for edge processing) or a large consumer base.

RackBank, another new entrant in the data centre business, is setting up its first facility in Raipur, largely on account of reliable and low-cost power supply, as well as access to relatively cheap land and local talent. Being in central India means that whichever direction the data is moving, the latency is unilateral, says Founder & CEO, Narendra Sen. The company is rethinking how a data centre is

## LOOKING AT THE HORIZON

• Investment priorities over the next three years



SOURCE IDC'S ASIA PACIFIC STATE OF DATA CENTER INFRASTRUCTURE SURVEY

constructed by creating a horizontal structure using pre-engineered buildings. “We’ve reduced the building time to six-seven months. Rather than a traditional real estate mindset where you think of going vertical, we are thinking from the technology side, so we’re building horizontal sites, as they are denser,” he says.

RackBank is not the only one which sees the potential in moving away from the metros. Techno Digital has tied up with PSU RailTel to set up 102 facilities across the country by 2030 under a 20-year revenue sharing partnership, in a move that Director and CEO Saraiya says will truly democratise access to high quality digital infra-

structure. These would range from 0.5 MW to 1 MW in most cases, with the option to scale up as needed.

The established players are a bit more cautious about this shift, while being open to the possibility of eventually moving out of the metros. “Edge data centres are primarily populated by content delivery platforms. These networks don’t process data, just relay it, so the storage and processing requirements are considerably lower,” says Rahul Dhar, President—Global Data Center Operations & Enterprise Delivery of CtrlS.

NTT, too, is considering expansion to smaller cities in the future. “Smaller and emerging cities can